

Child of God Theory

Scholars of cuneiform, Egyptian hieroglyphics, and early Semitic scripts often note the pictorial or ideographic elements of their earliest stages. Yet over time, interpretive traditions (particularly in Hebrew and Aramaic) shifted toward phonetic readings and the later imposition of vowel systems such as the Masoretic Niqud. These systems, while valuable for pronunciation and transmission, also carried theological and sectarian agendas that may have altered original meanings. For example, where the consonantal Hebrew word *עלמה* (*almah*) denotes “young woman,” the later insertion of vowel points rendered it as “virgin” in theological transmission, reshaping its significance in prophetic texts.

Using the JLD method we strip the word of later imposed Niqud vowel markers and breakdown the original Hebrew word of *almah* to render a conceptual sentence built into the very word itself.

Word: *Almah* (עלמה)

Traditional meaning: young woman of marriageable age, sometimes virgin, but focus is on youth and maturity of age.

Letter	Conceptual Meaning
- ע Ayin	Awareness; watching; insight; To see ¹⁷
- ל Lamed	Leadership; direction; control; Guiding authority ¹⁸
- מ Mem	Life; movement; generative force; Water ¹⁹
- ה Heh	What is revealed, an opening, divine exhalation. ²⁰

Reconstructed sentence: “*The one with insight and guidance from life, who brings revelation.*” or “*One that sees the direction of life through revelation*” or “*The one with awareness that guides and creates life through what is revealed*”.

This reconstruction frames *almah* as not simply a *young woman of marriageable age*, but a being that has been given mercy and grace from God to understand life and given the ability to bring something powerful into this world. It also does not point specifically to the concept of a woman who is sexually a virgin, but rather a powerful testament of who a young woman is to God, even that of Mary.

The Hebrew word for virgin, specifically, is *betulah*, but this word usually requires context to explicitly point toward sexual virginity. Let us take a moment to breakdown the word using the JLD methodology.

Word: *Betulah* (בתולה)

Traditional meaning: Virgin

Letter	Conceptual Meaning
- ב Bet	a container, household, inside place. ²¹
- ד Dalet	boundary, completion, sealing. ²²
- ו Vav	connection, joining together, continuation. ²³
- ל Lamed	to lead, to direct, authority. ²⁴
- ה Heh	what is revealed, an opening, divine breath. ²⁵

Reconstructed sentence: “*A sealed container of continuance that is guided through revealing*” or “*An enclosed boundary that connects and directs life*”.

The reconstructed sentences align with the traditional meaning of *betulah*, as a vessel of virginity, but provide a deeper, more conceptual image.

Through this methodology we can infer that the original language concerning Mary was more in line with her being a young woman of marriageable age, rather than that of a sexual virgin, for had the original text meant for sure, the word *betulah* would have been used instead of the word *almah*.

This theory is also supported by charting translations across Bibles (see chart below):

Stage	Language /Source	Rendering	Notes
Original Hebrew (Tanakh)	Hebrew (Isaiah 7:14; Gen 24:43; etc.)	<i>‘almāh</i> = “young woman of marriageable age”	Root meaning: simply a young woman, not necessarily “virgin.” Contrasted with <i>betulah</i> = technical term for “virgin.”
Septuagint (LXX, ~3rd–2nd c. BCE)	Greek	παρθένος (<i>parthenos</i>) = “virgin”	Jewish translators in Alexandria chose “virgin.” Important: <i>parthenos</i> usually means virgin, though it can also mean “young woman” in some Greek texts. This choice deeply influenced Christian interpretation.
Vulgate (Jerome, 4th c. CE)	Latin	<i>virgo</i> = “virgin”	Jerome, translating from Hebrew + Greek, kept “virgin,” aligning with Christian messianic prophecy of Christ’s virgin birth (Matt 1:23 quoting LXX).
Early English Bibles (Wycliffe 1382;	Middle English / Early Modern English	“virgin”	Followed the Latin Vulgate (<i>virgo</i>) rather than the Hebrew nuance.

Coverdale 1535)			
Bishops' Bible (1568)	English	“maiden”	The Bishops' Bible shifted toward “maiden” (closer to Hebrew <i>‘almāh</i> = young woman). “Maiden” carried the sense of youth, but not always strict virginity.
King James Version (1611)	English	“virgin”	The KJV returned to the Septuagint/Vulgate rendering “virgin,” reinforcing the Christological reading of Isaiah 7:14.
Modern Critical Translations (NRSV, ESV, etc.)	English	Often “young woman” (with footnote “or virgin”)	Many modern Bibles render it “young woman” to reflect Hebrew nuance, while noting the Christian tradition of “virgin” via LXX.

This theory further supports a new emerging thought that not only helps to clarify the story of the “virgin Mary” but to also make way for those that are born fatherless/ motherless or those that lose their parent(s) at a young age in this world to understand and see the prophetic role they play in the eyes of God, through His adoptive role as their guardian from birth.

While reviewing scripture I came to upon an observation that, just as Jesus was the child of God due to the lack of a covenanted father, there are other instances in scripture where this same pattern takes place, and those children, are pivotal heirs in the story of Christ.

I will map out each instance below and conclude with a chart that lists this pseudo-genealogical line through a genealogy of covenant, rather than direct bloodline.

Throughout scripture we can chain together persons that had Christ-like redeeming qualities or attributes that were all children of illegitimate conception, orphaned, adopted, or displaced by their blood parents, which gave God the opportunity to step in as the adoptive Father or Mother, earning his title as “Father to the fatherless” (Ps. 68.5; Deut. 10.18).

Child of God Line (Chronological with References)

→ **Abel** — *parentless by death (First Christ)*

- *Genesis 4.8–10* — Cain kills Abel, God hears his cry.
- *Hebrews 11.4* — Abel’s offering still “speaks.”

→ **Melchizedek** — *without father, mother, or genealogy.*

- *Genesis 14.18–20* — king of Salem, priest of El Elyon, blesses Abraham
- *Hebrews 7.1–3* — “Without father, without mother, without descent... made like unto the Son of God.”

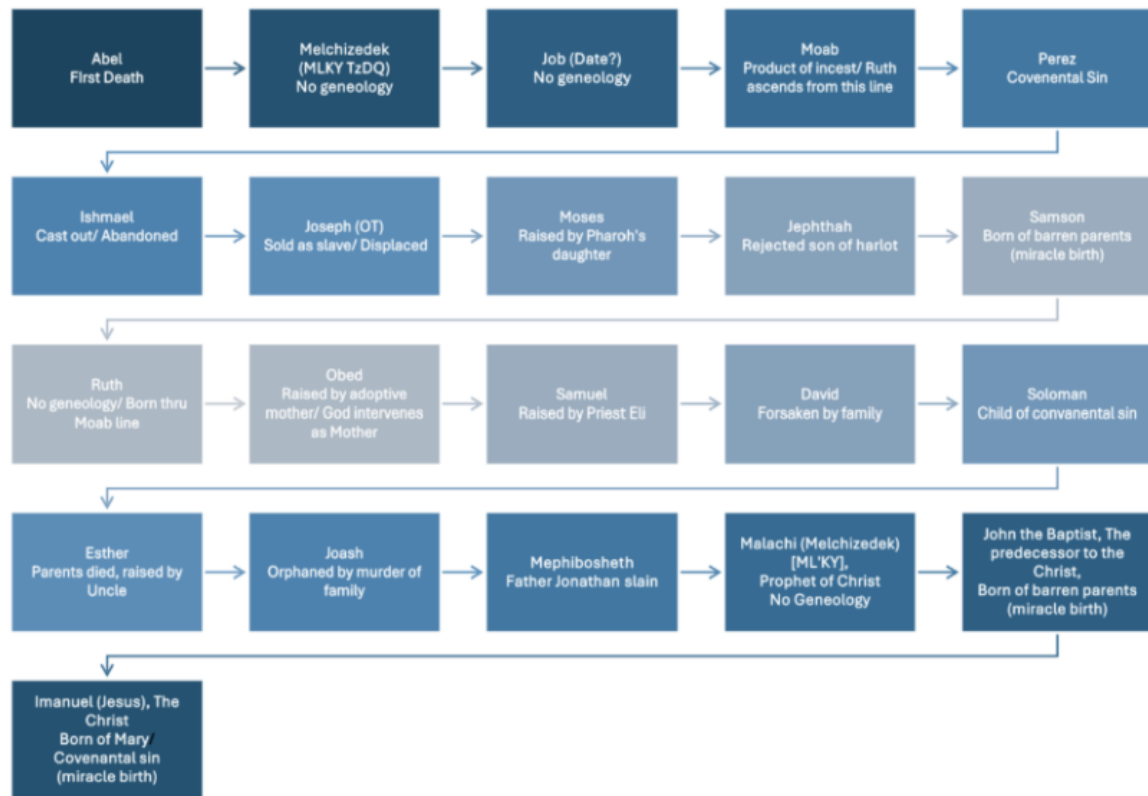
→ **Moab & Ben-Ammi (Lot’s Children)** — *born of incest.*

- *Genesis 19.30–38* — daughters conceive by Lot.
- *Ruth 1.4* — Ruth is Moabitess, later redeemed into line.
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- **Perez** — *illegitimate son of Judah & Tamar.*
 - *Genesis 38.29–30* — Perez born by breach of covenant.
 - *Matthew 1.3* — named in Christ's genealogy.
- **Ishmael** — *cast out, abandoned.*
 - *Genesis 21.17–18* — God hears his cry, promises a nation.
- **Joseph (OT)** — *rejected, displaced.*
 - *Genesis 37.28* — sold by brothers.
 - *Genesis 45.5–7; 50.20* — God used it for salvation.
- **Moses** — *given up, raised in Pharaoh's house.*
 - *Exodus 2.3, 10* — placed in basket, adopted by Pharaoh's daughter.
 - *Exodus 3.4* — God calls him personally.
- **Jephthah** — *son of a harlot, rejected.*
 - *Judges 11.1–2* — cast out by brothers.
 - *Judges 11.11* — God raises him as judge.
- **Samson** — *miracle child of barren woman.*
 - *Judges 13.2–5* — angel announces his birth, consecrated as Nazirite.
- **Ruth** — *displaced, parentless in record.*
 - *Ruth 1.16* — covenant vow: "Thy God shall be my God."
 - *Matthew 1.5* — named in genealogy.
- **Obed** — *son of Ruth & Boaz, given to Naomi.*
 - *Ruth 4.16–17* — "A son is born to Naomi."
- **Samuel** — *dedicated, raised in temple.*
 - *1 Samuel 1.28* — "lent to the LORD as long as he liveth."
- **David** — *forsaken by father/mother, chosen by God.*
 - *1 Samuel 16.11* — left out when Jesse presents sons.
 - *Psalms 27.10* — "When my father and mother forsake me, the LORD will take me up."
- **Solomon** — *born of scandal, renamed beloved of YHWH.*
 - *2 Samuel 12.24–25* — "The LORD loved him... called Jedidiah."
- **Job** — *no genealogy.*
 - *Job 1.1* — "There was a man in Uz..." (no parents named)
 - *Job 1.8* — "My servant Job."
- **Esther** — *orphan of both parents.*
 - *Esther 2.7* — "She had neither father nor mother."
- **Joash** — *orphaned, preserved in temple.*

- *2 Kings 11.1–2* — hidden after father killed, brothers slain.
- **Mephibosheth** — father Jonathan dead, crippled, displaced.
 - *2 Samuel 4.4* — dropped as child, lame.
 - *2 Samuel 9.6–7* — David restores him.
- **Malachi** — “*My messenger,*” *no genealogy.*
 - *Malachi 1.1* — simply “The burden of the word of the LORD to Israel by Malachi.”
- **John the Baptist** — *miracle child, Spirit-filled from womb, 2ND Anointed*
 - *Luke 1.7* — Elizabeth barren, stricken in years.
 - *Luke 1.15* — filled with Holy Spirit from womb.
- **Jesus Christ** — *fatherless covenantally, Son of God, 1ST Anointed (Isaiah 61.1)*
 - *Matthew 1.18–20* — conceived before Joseph “took” Mary.
 - *Luke 1.35* — angel: “He shall be called the Son of God.”

Mark 10:31 — “But many that are first shall be last; and the last first.”

Child of God Genealogy



* Imanuel is spelt transliterated from Hebrew, pre-Niqqudot, which denotes a single 'Mem' (or M).

The genealogy becomes a chiasm of **A - B - C - B - A

(Abel, the first Christ – Melchizedek, the first Righteous Priest King – Malichi, the Christ Prophet – John the Baptist, the Humble Priest – Jesus, the Christ)

This shows that, rather than hiding the birth of Christ beneath a veil of virginity out of fear, we should embrace the beauty revealed in these moments and acknowledge the truth behind a birth that remains special and sacred, even when viewed through this lens. The birth of Christ not only remains prophetic but also becomes the pinnacle of a generations-old covenant between God and those afflicted with the loss or separation of one or both parents. It provides hope for those who feel lost in this world, left in isolation, and seemingly lacking the love that has, in fact, been with them since their time of need.

Furthermore it provides explanation and gives purpose to those figures in history who